

flea

NEWS 63

December 2008



<http://www.entsoc.org/networks/Interest/fleanews.htm>

FLEA NEWS is a biannual newsletter about fleas (Siphonaptera). It is mainly bibliographic in nature, but recipients are urged to check any citations given here before including them in publications. Many of our sources are abstracting journals and current literature sources such as Current Contents(R), National Agricultural Library (NAL) Agricola, and National Library of Medicine (NLM) Medline, and citations have not necessarily been checked for accuracy or consistent formatting.

Recipients are urged to contribute items of interest to the profession for inclusion herein, including: Flea research citations from journals that are not indexed in Agricola or Medline databases, Announcements and Requests for material, Contact information for a Directory of Siphonapterists (name, mailing address, email address, and areas of interest - Systematics, Ecology, Control, etc.), Abstracts of research planned or in progress, Book reviews, Biography, Hypotheses and Literature Reviews, and Anecdotes. Send to:

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Announcements

A Request – As adviser of Daniel M. de Avelar in developing of the Ph.D. thesis about systematics and cladistics of the genus *Tunga* Jarocki, 1838, we would greatly appreciate receiving slides and preserved material in alcohol (including neosomes), mainly of the species: *Tunga caecigena* Jordan & Rothschild, 1921; *Tunga callida* Li & Chin, 1957; *Tunga libis* Smit, 1962; *Tunga monositus* Barnes & Radovsky, 1969, and *Tunga trimamillata* Pampliglione, Trentini, Fioravanti, Onore & Rivasi, 2002.

If anyone can provide assistance, please contact us at the address:
 Prof. Pedro M. Linardi, Departamento de Parasitologia, Instituto de Ciências Biológicas, Universidade Federal de Minas Gerais, Caixa Postal 486, CEP 31.270-901, Belo Horizonte, Minas Gerais, Brasil, e-mail: <linardi@icb.ufmg.br> or <aveldan@gmail.com>

“Functional and evolutionary ecology of fleas : a model for ecological parasitology” (2008) by Boris R. Krasnov is now available from Cambridge University Press. It is a comprehensive review of flea ecology from autecology to community ecology. Particularly of interest are the many Russian and Eastern European references to flea research.

Optomen USA and Animal Planet are currently producing a new science series on parasites and their effects on the human body. Each episode will focus in on one place in the human body that parasites attack. The past and present stories of human infection will be the primary focus. Patients will be sensitively interviewed about their experiences with doctors and scientific experts providing the science behind the story.

We are looking for past and present patients of parasitic infection to share their story with us as well as their doctors and experts on the subject. Our aim is to enlighten the general public on the dangers of parasites and how precautions and prevention can be taken in the future.

If you think you can be of help in locating these case studies, or are interested in finding out more about the series, please contact:

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The International Society for Pest Information (ISPI) is a non-profit organization, registered in Darmstadt, Germany, with the aim to promote information exchange on: animal pests, diseases and weeds in agriculture, forestry and stores arthropods (e.g. insects) which are harmful to livestock or affect humans directly.

Mailing address:

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A new systemic residual in dogs, Comfortis, has been launched that activates nicotinic acetylcholine receptors (nAChRs) in insects. (<http://www.comfortis4dogs.com>)

All volumes of Flea News from Volume 1, and on, are now archived on the Entomological Society of America's network website. Thank you to everyone who contributed!

Members of the Entomological Society of America can log directly onto the Networks to access the archived Flea News. The ability of non-members to log onto the Networks is still not available, so if you want any of the archived volumes, please contact the Editor.

<http://www.entsoc.org/networks/Interest/fleanews.htm>

Meetings

In case you want to go ahead and block out the dates on your 2009 calendar, the **10th International Symposium on Ectoparasites of Pets** will be held in Toulouse, France, **June 3-5, 2009**. Professor Michel Franc will be hosting this event. Deadline for submissions will be February 28, 2009; additional information is on the website <http://vet-isep2009.com>.

ESA 57th Annual Meeting, Celebrate Entomology: Colleagues, Science, and Ideas
Jan. 23: Program Symposia proposals due online, Feb. 20: Program Symposia selections announced, Feb. 27: All Section Symposia and Symposia proposals due online, Mar. 30: Section Symposia and Symposia selections announced.

North American Veterinary Conference January 17 - 21 info@tnavc.org

Association of Applied IPM Ecologists Ecological Pest Management Conference & 43rd Annual Meeting, February 1-3, 2009, Doubletree Hotel, Modesto, California.

Michigan Mosquito Control Association, 23rd Annual Conference February 4-5, 2009, Four Points, Sheraton Ann Arbor, Ann Arbor, Michigan. <http://www.mimosq.org>
jmclaughlin@co.midland.mi.us.

3rd International Symposium on Biological Control of Arthropods, February 8-13, 2009, Christchurch, New Zealand. events.lincoln.ac.nz/isbca09/default.htm

The International Symposium on the Asian Tiger Mosquito, Center for Vector Biology at Rutgers University, February 12-13, 2009.
Kristen Bartlett-Healy, krisb@rci.rutgers.edu. Mark P. Nelder, PhD, mnelder@rci.rutgers.edu, <http://www.rci.rutgers.edu/~vbcenter/atmsymposium.php>

IMED 2009 - International Meeting on Emerging Diseases and Surveillance
Vienna, Austria February 13 – 16 info@isid.org

Western Veterinary Conference February 15 - 19 Las Vegas, United States carolyn@wvc.org

Eurasia Veterinary Conference Bali February 16 - 20 Bali, Indonesia info@eurasia-vc.com

Annual Meeting of the Southwestern Branch of the Entomological Society of America, February 23-26, 2009, Stillwater, Oklahoma.

Annual Meeting of the Southeastern Branch of the Entomological Society of America, March 8–11, 2009, Renaissance Hotel and Spa, Montgomery, Alabama.

Annual Meeting of the North Central Branch of the Entomological Society of America, March 15-18, 2009, Hilton at the Ballpark, St. Louis, Missouri.

Annual Meeting of the Eastern Branch of the Entomological Society of America, March 20-23, 2009, Harrisburg, Pennsylvania, Hilton and Towers.

Sixth International IPM Symposium, "Transcending Boundaries," March 24-26, 2009 at the Oregon Convention Center, Portland, Oregon. wolffl@uiuc.edu, www.ipmcenters.org/ipmsymposium09

Midwest Ecology and Evolution Conference, University of Nebraska-Lincoln from March 27-29, 2009. www.midwesteec.org.

93rd Annual Meeting of the Pacific Branch of the Entomological Society of America, March 29 – April 1, 2008, Bahia Resort Hotel On Mission Bay, San Diego, California.

6th Annual Arbovirus Surveillance and Mosquito Control Workshop , AMCD, St. Augustine, Florida, March 31-April 2, 2009. www.anastasiamcd.org.

British Small Animal Veterinary Association April 2 - 5 British Small Animal Veterinary Association (BSAVA) Birmingham, United Kingdom

PestEx 2009 will be held at Excel in London, UK, April 22-23, 2009. frances@activesolutions.uk.com.

European Veterinary Conference - Voorjaarsdagen April 23 - 25 Amsterdam, Netherlands info@voorjaarsdagen.org

Australian Veterinary Association Annual Conference 2009 May 17 - 22 Darwin, Australia

The International Forum for Surveillance and Control of Mosquitoes and Mosquito-Borne Diseases May 25-29, 2009 Beijing, China. xueamcd@bellsouth.net.

Animal Behavior Society - 46th Annual Meeting June 22 - 26 Pirenopolis, Brazil rhfmacedo@unb.br

American Veterinary Medical Association Annual Convention July 11 - 14 Seattle, United States AVMA Convention Office avmainfo@avma.org

11th International Congress of the European Association for Veterinary Pharmacology and Toxicology July 12 - 17 Leipzig, Germany

Caribbean Wildlife and Veterinary Medicine July 12 - 24 St Augustine, Trinidad And Tobago

34th Annual World Small Animal Veterinary Association Congress - WSAVA 2009 July 21 – 24 ana.elia@nielsen.com

WDA annual meeting, Edmonton, Alberta, August 2008. "Wildlife Diseases: Northern and Western Frontiers." <http://www.biology.ualberta.ca/parasites/WDA08/>

XII International Symposium on Veterinary Epidemiology and Economics August 6 – 11
International Convention Centre, Durban, South Africa Bruce.Gummow@up.ac.za

22nd World Association for the Advancement of Parasitology August 8 - 13 Calgary, Canada
blair@meet-ics.com

American Society of Parasitologists, 84th Annual Meeting, August 14-17, 2009
Knoxville Tennessee.

8th Meeting on Soil Insect Pests August 26-28, 2009, Monterrey, Mexico.
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American Association of Feline Practitioners (AAFP) 2009 - Fall Conference September 19 – 21
Denver, United States American Association of Feline Practitioners (AAFP)
info@aafponline.org

British Veterinary Association Congress September 24 - 26 Cardiff, United Kingdom

XVIIth International Congress for Tropical Medicine and Malaria (ICTM2008), Jeju Island,
Korea, September 29 - October 3, 2008. <http://www.ictm17.org>

Southern European Veterinary Conference (SEVC) and Congreso Nacional de AVEPA October
2 - 4 Barcelona, Spain sevre@sevc.info

Belgian International Congress - Small Animal Veterinarians and Equine Veterinarians and
Farriers October 10 - November 11 Liège, Belgium info@animalia.be

2009 ESA Annual Meeting December 13-16, 2009, Indianapolis Convention Center in
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Siphonaptera Presentations

The following papers were presented at meetings.

At the 2008 AAVP (American Association of Veterinary Parasitologists) 53rd Annual Meeting in New Orleans (http://www.aavp.org/pg_am.shtml):

The effect of four insecticides on the feeding of cat fleas placed on cats. Christine M. McCoy*, Alberto B. Broce, Rudolf Schenker, and Michael W. Dryden.

Introducing Comfortis™ - Spinosad discovery & development. Anthony Rumschlag*.

Why develop an oral flea adulticide? James R. McDougall*.

Oral pulicides can be more effective in stopping fleas feeding. Christine M. McCoy*.

The safety profile of spinosad and post-launch field experience. Lori A. Thompson*.

Studies investigating the effectiveness of orally administered spinosad in dogs under laboratory and field conditions. Daniel E. Snyder*

In vivo adulticide activity of a flea dermal treatment against the cat flea (*Ctenocephalides felis*) on cats in a comparative efficacy study versus Imidacloprid. Martin Murphy, Albert Ahn*, Sheila Gross, and Cathy Ann Ball

Common myths about fleas and flea control. Byron L. Blagburn

At the ESA annual meeting in Reno, Nevada November 16-19 2008, only 2 presentations on fleas were found:

Gene expression patterns in flea vectors of *Yersinia pestis*
(Wei Zhou, lianzi8693@gmail.com, Richard Mortensen, richdmort@earthlink.net, Vance Mitchell, Kody Johnson, and David Erickson, xenopsylla@gmail.com. Brigham Young University, Microbiology & Molecular Biology Department, Provo, UT).

Genetic variation of the cat flea
(Jackie Mckern, jmckern@uark.edu1, A. L. Szalanski, aszalan@uark.edu1, and James W. Austin, jwaustin@ag.tamu.edu2. (1) University of Arkansas, Department of Entomology, 319 agri bldg, Fayetteville, AR, (2) Texas A&M University, Center for Urban & Structural Entomology, 2143 TAMU, College Station, TX).

Siphonaptera Literature June 2008-December 2008

- Abraham, Rudolf, and Ralph S. Peters. 2008. "Nestboxes as habitat for insects, especially for flies and their parasitoids." *Vogelwarte* 46, no. 3.
- Adjemian, Jennifer Zipser, Michael K Adjemian, Patrick Foley, Bruno B Chomel, Rickie W Kasten, and Janet E Foley. 2008. "Evidence of multiple zoonotic agents in a wild rodent community in the eastern Sierra Nevada." *Journal Of Wildlife Diseases* 44, no. 3: 737-742.
- Ammerman, Nicole C, M Sayeedur Rahman, and Abdu F Azad. 2008. "Characterization of Sec-translocon-dependent extracytoplasmic proteins of *Rickettsia typhi*." *Journal Of Bacteriology* 190, no. 18: 6234-6242.
- Anon. "Mapping the Fleabite." *Times, The (United Kingdom)*.
- Anon. 2008. "A Flea Grows in Brooklyn." *Country Living* 31, no. 11: 67-68.
- Anon. 2008. "Armadillos, Fleas, and Slime Mold: the 2008 Ig Nobel Prizes." *Chronicle of Higher Education* 55, no. 7: A6-A6.
- Anon. 2008. "Dermatology: what's your Dx? A flea-bitten baby?." *Contemporary Pediatrics* 25, no. 11: 33-34.
- Anon. 2008. "FDA Issues Parasite-Treatment Warming." *Dog World* 93, no. 0: 8.
- Anon. 2008. "FDA issues safety warning on Comfortis ivermectin interaction." *Journal of the American Veterinary Medical Association* 233, no. 2: 206-206.
- Anon. 2008. "Fleas and ticks." *Woman's Day* 71, no. 9: 152-152.
- Anon. 2008. "Fleas." *Pest Management Professional* 76, no. 7: 9-10.
- Anon. 2008. "Free of fleas." *Good Housekeeping* 246, no. 5: 39-39.
- Anon. 2008. "Ig Nobel winner - fleas on a dog jump higher than fleas on a cat." *Irish Times* .
- Anon. 2008. "Illnesses and injuries related to total release foggers--eight states, 2001-2006." *MMWR: Morbidity and Mortality Weekly Report* 57, no. 41: 1125-1129.
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- Bazanov, L P, and T I Innokent'eva. 2008. "[Role of fleas, the principal and secondary plague vectors, in the circulation of the causative agent in Siberian natural foci]." *Meditinskaiia Parazitologiya I Parazitarnye Bolezni* , no. 3: 54-60.
- Ben-Zvi, Ilan, Eyal Meltzer, Olga Feld, and Ilan Bank. 2008. "A case of murine typhus associated with large vessel infarct of the spleen." *The American Journal Of The Medical Sciences* 335, no. 6: 502-503.
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- Bloom, Connie. 2008. "No shortcuts to flea control." *Akron Beacon Journal (OH)* .
- Breitschwerdt, Edward B. 2008. "Feline bartonellosis and cat scratch disease [electronic resource]." *Veterinary immunology and immunopathology* 123,: 167-171.
- Brinkerhoff, R. Jory, Chris Ray, Bala Thiagarajan, Sharon K. Collinge, Jack F., Jr. Cully, Brian Holmes, and Kenneth L. Gage. 2008. "Prairie dog presence affects occurrence patterns of disease vectors on small mammals." *Ecography* 31, no. 5.
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- Carpenter, Kenneth J. 2008. "Harriette Chick and the problem of rickets." *Journal of Nutrition* 138, no. 5.
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- Coleman, Jennifer. 2008. "Fleas!" *Library Media Connection* 27, no. 2: 67-67.
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- Davis, M Keith, J Scott Boone, John E Moran, John W Tyler, and Janice E Chambers. 2008. "Assessing intermittent pesticide exposure from flea control collars containing the organophosphorus insecticide tetrachlorvinphos." *Journal of Exposure Science & Environmental Epidemiology* 18, no. 6: 564-570.
- Davis, S., P. Trapman, H. Leirs, M. Begon, and J. A. P. Heesterbeek. 2008. "The abundance threshold for plague as a critical percolation phenomenon." *Nature* 454, no. 7204: 634-637.
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- Dymond, N L, and I M Swift. 2008. "Permethrin toxicity in cats: a retrospective study of 20 cases." *Australian Veterinary Journal* 86, no. 6: 219-223.
- Eisen, Rebecca J, Borchert, Jeff N, Holmes, Jennifer L, Amatre, Gerald, Van Wyk, Kristen, Ensore, Russell E, Babi, Nackson, et al. 2008. "Early-phase transmission of *Yersinia pestis* by cat fleas (*Ctenocephalides felis*) and their potential role as vectors in a plague-endemic region of Uganda." *The American Journal Of Tropical Medicine And Hygiene* 78, no. 6: 949-956.
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- Engberg, Gillian. 2008. "Fleas!" *Booklist* 104, no. 18: 47.
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- Erickson, David L., Clayton O. Jarrett, Julie A. Callison, Elizabeth R. Fischer, and B. Joseph Hinnebusch. 2008. "Loss of a Biofilm-Inhibiting Glycosyl Hydrolase during the Emergence of *Yersinia pestis*." *Journal of Bacteriology* 190, no. 24: 8163-8170.
- Escamilla-Martinez, Elena, Beatriz Gómez-Martín, Raquel Sánchez-Rodríguez, Alfonso Martínez-Nova, Luis Martínez-Granada, and Edurne Altube-Arabiurrutia. 2008. "Tungiasis - Traveler's Ectoparasitosis of the Foot: A Case Report." *Foot & Ankle International* 29, no. 3: 354-357.
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- Gallizzi, Katharina, and Heinz Richner. 2008. "A parasite-induced maternal effect can reduce survival times of fleas feeding on great tit nestlings [electronic resource]." *Oikos, acta oecologica Scandinavica* 117,: 1209-1217.
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Obituary (Dr. Cluff Hopla)

Dr. Cluff Hopla, George Lynn Cross Research Professor Emeritus of Zoology at the University of Oklahoma, passed away Thursday, October 30, 2008. Dr. Hopla had retired from the University of Oklahoma in 1988 and for the past 10 years had been living in Martin, Tennessee, near his daughter. Dr. Hopla worked extensively with ectoparasites, investigating their biology and behavior as well as their roles as vectors.

Dr. Hopla was actively involved in several professional societies including the Entomological Society of America, the American Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene, and the Society for Vector Ecology. Among his many awards and recognitions, Dr. Hopla received SOVE's Distinguished Achievement Award (1994).

Condolences can be mailed to the family at 136 Glenwood Dr., Martin, TN 38237.

A more detailed obituary will be included in the Journal of Vector Ecology.

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